PRATEEKSHIT "KANU" PANDEY

[kanupandey@ucsb.edu] [Twitter/X]

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Assistant Professor of Communication *Nov 2023 - current*
Department of Communication, University of California, Santa Barbara

Postdoctoral Fellow *Sept 2022 - Sept 2023*
Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania
Joint appointment between Communication Neuroscience Lab (PI: Prof. Emily Falk) and Center for Advanced Research in Global Communication (PI: Prof. Aswin Punathambekar)

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Communication *Aug 2016 - Aug 2022*
Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania
Dissertation: *Disentangling the reciprocal causal relationship between political efficacy and sharing traditional and humorous political information.*
Committee: Prof. Emily Falk (chair), Prof. Joseph N. Cappella, Prof. Michael Delli-Carpini, Prof. Dannagal Young

Master of Arts, Communication *Aug 2016 - May 2018*
Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania

Bachelor of Technology, Computer Science & Engineering *Aug 2012 - Aug 2016*
IIIT-Delhi, India
Best Undergraduate Research Thesis Award (top in department)
Thesis: *Face Recognition with Obfuscation*
Advisors: Prof. Richa Singh, Prof. Mayak Vatsa

PUBLICATIONS

Pandey, P. (2026). Political memes as pedagogy for globally situated political communication. In Coe, K. & Zulli, D. (Ed.), *Teaching Political Communication.* Edward Elgar Publishing. doi: 10.4337/9781035347780.00024

Pandey, P. (2024). Humor and Mirth. In Bowman, N. (Ed.), *Entertainment Media and Communication.* De Gruyter. doi: 10.1515/9783110792881-004

Cosme, D., Scholz, C., Chan, H. Y., Doré, B. P., **Pandey, P.**, Carreras-Tartak, J., Cooper, N., Paul, A., Burns, S. M., & Falk, E. B. (2023). Message self and social relevance increases intentions to share content: Correlational and causal evidence from six studies. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, doi: 10.1037/xge0001270

Singh, M., Nagpal, S., Yadav, D., Kohli, N., **Pandey, P.**, Prabhakaran, G., Singh, R., Vatsa, M., Noore, A., Brefczynski-Lewis, J. & Mahajan, H. (2021). Understanding Neural Responses to Face Verification of Cross-Domain Representations. *2021 International Joint Conference on Neural Networks (IJCNN)* (pp. 1-8). doi: 10.1109/IJCNN52387.2021.9534242

Jovanova, M., Falk, E. B., Parelman J., **Pandey P.**, O'Donnell, M. B., Kang, Y., Bassett, D. S., & Lydon-Staley, D. M. (2022). Brain System Integration and Message Consistent Health Behavior Change. *Health Psychology, 41*(9), 611–620. doi: 10.1037/hea0001201

Pandey, P., Kang, Y., Cooper, N., O'Donnell, M. B., & Falk, E. B. (2021). Social networks and neural receptivity to persuasive health messages. *Health Psychology, 40*(4), 285–294. doi: 10.1037/hea0001059

Kang, Y., Cosme, D., Pei, R., **Pandey, P.**, Carreras-Tartak, J., & Falk, E. B. (2021). Purpose in life, loneliness, and protective health behaviors during the COVID-19 pandemic. *The Gerontologist, 61*(6), 878–887. doi: 10.1093/geront/gnab081

Coronel, J. C., O'Donnell, M. B., **Pandey P.**, Delli Carpini, M. X., & Falk E. B. (2021). Political Humor, Sharing, and Remembering: Insights from Neuroimaging, *Journal of Communication, 71*(1), 129-161, doi: 10.1093/joc/jqaa041

Pandey, P. (2020). Caty Borum Chattoo and Lauren Feldman, A Comedian and an Activist Walk into a Bar: The Serious Role of Comedy in Social Justice. *International Journal of Communication, 14*, 3. Retrieved from https://ijoc.org/index.php/ijoc/article/view/16728

Kang, Y., Cooper, N., **Pandey, P.**, Scholz, C., O'Donnell, M. B., Lieberman, M. D., Taylor, S. E., Strecher, V. J., Cin, S. D., Konrath, S., Polk, T. A., Resnicow, K., An, L., & Falk, E. B. (2018). Effects of self-transcendence on neural responses to persuasive messages and health behavior change. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America, 115*(40), 9974–9979. doi: 10.1073/pnas.1805573115.

Yadav D., Kohli N., Nagpal S., Singh M., **Pandey P.**, Vatsa M., Singh R., & Noore A. (2017). Region-specific fMRI Dictionary for Decoding Face Verification in Humans, *2017 International Joint Conference on Neural Networks*, pp. 3814-3821, doi: 10.1109/IJCNN.2017.7966337.

Pandey P., Singh R., & Vatsa M. (2016). Face Recognition using Scattering Wavelet under Illicit Drug Abuse Variations, *In Proceedings of International Conference on Biometrics (ICB) 2016*. pp. 1-6, doi: 10.1109/ICB.2016.7550091.

Yadav D., Kohli N., **Pandey P.**, Singh R., Vatsa M., & Noore A. (2016). Effect of Illicit Drug Abuse on Face Recognition, *In Proceedings of Winter Conference on Applications of Computer Vision (WACV)*. pp. 1-7, doi: 10.1109/WACV.2016.7477556. ***Received Best Paper Award** when presented at WACV 2016.

Sankaran A., **Pandey P.**, Vatsa M., & Singh R. (2014). On Latent Fingerprint Minutiae Extraction using Stacked Denoising Sparse AutoEncoders, *In Proceedings of International Joint Conference on Biometrics*. pp. 1-7, doi: 10.1109/BTAS.2014.6996300. ***Received Best Poster Award** when presented at IJCB 2014.

HONORS AND AWARDS

Top Paper Award at Communication Science & Biology interest group, ICA Conference	*May 2023*
Dissertation Research Fellowship at Annenberg School for Communication, UPenn	*Jan 2021*
Top Paper Award at Communication Science & Biology interest group, ICA Annual Conference	*May 2020*
GAPSA Student Travel Award to attend SANS 2019	*May 2019*
SANS Poster Award at SANS Conference, Brooklyn NY	*May 2018*
Top 5 Paper Award at Communication Science & Biology interest group, ICA Annual Conference	*Jun 2017*
Best Teaching Assistant Award (for my role as TA for Image Analysis course at IIIT-Delhi)	*Aug 2016*
Best Paper Award at IEEE WACV, Lake Placid	*Mar 2016*
Selected for **Indian Academy of Science Summer Fellowship**	*Apr 2015*
Best Poster Award at IEEE International Joint Conference on Biometrics (IJCB), Florida	*Oct 2014*
INSPIRE Scholarship by DST, New Delhi (top 1% students in CBSE)	*Jul 2012*

PREGISTERED STUDIES

Pandey, P., Falk, E. B., Young, D. G., Carpini, M. X. D. (2025, Dec 17). Effects of political affirmation on internal and collective political efficacy. *Retrieved from https://osf.io/jcuq8/.*

Wright, J., **Pandey, P.**, McClennen, S. (2025, Jul 9). How Humorous Message Shapes Perceptions of Non-violent Protests. *Retrieved from https://osf.io/dgvza/.*

Lee, H., **Pandey, P.**, Kam, J., Madrigal, G. (2025, June 16). Effects of Humorous Counter speech on Immigrant Support and Perceptions. *Retrieved from https://osf.io/98rch/.*

Wright, J., Swim, J., **Pandey, P.**, McClennen, S. (2024, Oct 28). How Humor Shapes Perceptions of Non-violent Protests. *Retrieved from https://osf.io/4xt6p/.*

Pandey, P., Falk, E. B., Young, D. G., Carpini, M. X. D. (2022, May 23). Effects of news sharing on political efficacy. *Retrieved from osf.io/zg8qa.*

Pandey, P. (2021, November 16). Civic affirmation intervention pre-registration. *Retrieved from osf.io/ed8pw.*

Pandey, P. (2021, November 5). Effect of civic affirmation on news sharing behavior. *Retrieved from osf.io/7qunk.*

Cosme, D., Falk, E. B., Dore, B. P., Scholz, C., O'Donnell, M. B., Kang, Y., Cooper, N., Lauharatanahirun, N., Mattan, B. D., Pei, R., Jovanova, M., Pearl, J., **Pandey, P.** (2020, May 17). Framing effects on the effectiveness and virality of health messages related to COVID-19. *Retrieved from osf.io/8hn2g.*

Kang, Y., Cosme, D., Falk, E. B., Dore, B. P., Scholz, C., O'Donnell, M. B., Lauharatanahirun, N., Mattan, B. D., Pei, R., Jovanova, M., Pearl, J., **Pandey, P.** (2020, April 7). Purpose in life, health messages receptivity, and loneliness among older adults during COVID-19 pandemic. *Retrieved from osf.io/t5f2k.*

CONFERENCE AND SYMPOSIA PRESENTATIONS

Lydic, K., **Pandey, P.**, Falk, E. (2026) Playing our way to utopia: a framework for bridging deliberation and participatory performance art to support democratic innovation *Accepted for presentation at the International Association for Media and Communication Research Annual Conference, June-July 2026.*

Lee, H., **Pandey, P.**, Kam, J., Madrigal, G. (2026). Effects of humorous counterspeech on perceptions of undocumented immigrants *Presented at the Politics of Race, Immigration, and Ethnicity Consortium at UC Santa Barbara, May 2026.*

Pandey, P., Lane, D., Wang, Y., Ismail, I. (2023). Humor Consumption and Consequences in the 2024 US Presidential Election *Presented at the Comm Horizons Conference at UC Davis, May 2025.*

Jovanova, M., **Pandey, P.**, Boyd, Z., Schwarze, A., Kang, Y., Cosme, D., Bassett, D., Ochsner, K., Mucha, P., Lydon-Staley, D. M., Falk, E. B. (2023). A person specific approach to study health behavior: proof of concept with alcohol use *Presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference, May 2022.* ***Top paper award**.

Pandey, P., Falk, E. F., Young, D. G., Delli-Carpini M. X. (2021). Effect of Political Efficacy on News Sharing Behavior *Presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference, May 2022.*

Pandey, P., Falk, E. F., Garcia, J. O., Lauharatanahirun, N. (2021). Neural synchrony during social communication: a comparison of functional brain network metrics. *Presented at Networks 2021, July 2021.*

Pandey, P., Falk, E. F., Garcia, J. O., Lauharatanahirun, N. (2021). Neural synchrony during social coordination: a comparison of functional connectivity measures. *Presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference, May 2021.*

Cosme D., **Pandey P.**, Carreras-Tartak, J., Cooper, N., Paul, A., Burns, S. M., Falk, E. B. (2021). Message Self and Social Relevance is Positively Associated With Sharing Intentions: Correlational Evidence From Four Studies *Presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference, May 2021.*

Jovanova, M., Falk, E. B., Parelman J., **Pandey P.**, O'Donnell, M. B., Kang, Y., Bassett, D. S., & Lydon-Staley, D. M. (2020). Default Mode and Salience Brain Network Integration During Messaging Predicts Health Behavior Change. *Presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference, May 2020..*

Pandey, P., Coronel, J., O'Donnell, Delli Carpini, M. X., Falk, E. B. (2019). Neural correlates of political efficacy: Brain activity in response to civic information associated with political efficacy. *Presented at the Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Annual Conference, Miami Beach, Florida, May 2019.*

Pandey, P., Coronel, J., O'Donnell, Delli Carpini, M. X., Falk, E. B. (2019). Neural correlates of political efficacy: Brain activity in response to civic information associated with political efficacy. *Presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference, Washington D.C., May 2019.*

Pandey, P., Vettel, J. M., Cohen, A. Paul, J. A., Falk, E. B., Garcia, J. O. The precision and stability of imagination: Reconstructing colors from oscillatory neural activity. *Presented at Neuroscience 2018, Annual Meeting of Society for Neuroscience, San Diego, Nov 2018.*

Pandey, P. & Revati Prasad. The Great Bollywood Roast: Exploring Representations of Sexuality Before and After AIB Knockout. *Presented at Representations in Bollywood Symposium at Birmingham City University, UK, May 2018.*

Pandey, P., Kang, Y., Cooper, N., Scholz, C., O'Donnell, M. B., Falk, E. B. Social Influences on Health Behavior: Physical Activity across Social Network Influences Neural Responses to Health Messages and Behavior Change. *Presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference, Prague, Czech Republic, May 2018.*

Pandey, P., Kang, Y., Cooper, N., Scholz, C., O'Donnell, M. B., Falk, E. B. Social Influences on Health Message Reception: Physical Activity Across Individuals' Social Networks Is Associated With Neural Receptivity to Health Messages. *Presented at the Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Annual Conference, Brooklyn, New York, May 2018.* ***SANS poster award**.

Kang, Y., **Pandey, P.**, Cooper, N., Scholz, C., O'Donnell, M. B., Elliott, A. M., Pegors, T. K., Lieberman, M. D., Taylor, S. E., Strecher, V. J., Dal Cin, S., Konrath, S., Polk, T., Resnicow, K., An, L., Falk, E. B. Increasing Receptivity to Health Communications: Effects of Self-Transcendence and Affirmation Priming on Neural Responses to Health Messages and Behavior Change. *Presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference, San Diego, California, May 2017.* ***Top 5 paper award**.

RESEARCH GRANTS

Senate Faculty Research Grant, UCSB – $20,000 *June 2024*
Faculty Research Assistant Program, UCSB – $1,750 *May 2024*
Pilot Grant for DEI Comedy Shows, Rutgers University Camden – $6,250 *June 2024*

TEACHING

COMM130 Political Communication University of California, Santa Barbara
Instructor, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Winter 2025

COMM187 Data Science in Communication Research University of California, Santa Barbara
Instructor, Spring 2024, Fall 2024

Graduate Teaching Assistant University of Pennsylvania
COMM282 Sick and Satired – The Insanity of Humor and How It Keeps Us Sane (Fall 2017)

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant IIIT-Delhi
MTH201 Probability and Statistics (Winter 2015)
CSE340/540 Image Analysis (Monsoon 2015)
HSS212 Critical Thinking (Winter 2016)

MENTORSHIP

Graduate Committees University of California, Santa Barbara

Hyojin Lee, *Co-advisor* *Expected Grauduation in 2027*
Yidi Wang, *Member* *Expected Grauduation in 2027*
Musa Malik, *Member* *Expected Grauduation in 2027*

Undergraduate Honors Thesis University of Pennsylvania

Sarah Fendrich, *Graduate Mentor, Spring 2020* *Graduated in 2020*

INVITED TALKS AND GUEST LECTURES

How Political Humor Engages the Brain: Neural Mechanisms of Learning and Sharing
Cognition, Perception, and Cognitive Neuroscience (CPCN) Semina, UC Santa Barbara *January 2025*

"Hahaha... oh wait" or, How humor makes us think about politics
Lambda Pi Eta Choice Scholar Lecture, UC Santa Barbara *April 2024*

Public Speaking in Academia
Center for Advanced Research in Global Communication India Doctoral Institute, New Delhi, India *March 2024*

Political Humor, Sharing, and Socially-Oriented Thinking
Guest Lecture, COMM 213 Mass Media, the Individual, and Society, Winter 2024, UCSB *Feb 2024*

Playing with Politics: Humor and its effects on citizenship
Civic Studios, Mumbai, India *Dec 2023*

Media and the Brain: Lessons from neuroimaging in health and political communication
School of Artificial Intelligence and Data Science, Indian Institute of Technology, Jodhpur, India *Nov 2023*

How does humor shape citizenship
Department of Communication, University of Hyderabad, India *Nov 2023*

Political humor, Sharing, and Remembering: Insights from Neuroimaging
School of International Affairs, Pennsylvania State University *Sept 2023*

Political Humor and Citizenship in Digital India: A Review
CARGC Postdoctoral Colloquium, University of Pennsylvania *May 2023*

News Comedy, Political Efficacy, and How Social Thinking Constitutes Democratic Citizenship
Political Communication Speaker Series, University of California, Santa Barbara *Jan 2023*

Research Talk
Graduate Seminar on Philosophy of Science and Communication Studies, University of Delaware *Oct 2019*

Political Entertainment in the US
Popular Culture and Media, University of Pennsylvania *June 2019*

PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

Pandey, P., Lane, D. (2024) Partisan memes and how they were perceived in the 2024 U.S. presidential election, *U.S. Election Analysis 2024: Media, Voters and the Campaign*, Retreived from https://www.electionanalysis.ws/us/president2024/7-popular-culture/partisan-memes-and-how-they-were-perceived-in-the-2024-us-presidential-election/

Lane, D., **Pandey, P.** (2024) Perceptions of social media in the 2024 presidential election, *U.S. Election Analysis 2024: Media, Voters and the Campaign*, Retreived from https://www.electionanalysis.ws/us/president2024/section-6-digital-campaign/perceptions-of-social-media-in-the-2024-presidential-election/

MEDIA PUBLICATION

Fisher, B. & de Sousa, A. M. (2024, July 9). S3 E21: Your Mind on Political Humor & Satire with Prateekshit "Kanu" Pandey *Minds Matter Podcast* Retrieved from https://www.mindsmatterpodcast.com/podcast/episode/3337c2f0/s3-e21-your-mind-on-political-humor-and-satire-with-prateekshit-kanu-pandey

Steinberg, D. (2023, October 12). With comedy-and-science game show, Public Health takes the improv stage. *News & Events, College of Public Health, Temple University.* Retrieved from https://cph.temple.edu/about/news-events/news/comedy-and-science-game-show-public-health-takes-improv-stage

Hopkins, E. (2023, March 4). Philly comedians find more laughs with an expanding indie stand-up scene. *The Philadelphia Inquirer.* Retrieved from https://www.inquirer.com/entertainment/philadelphia-comedy-scene-20230304.html

Scripps News Staff. (2023, January 26). Why audiences are getting their news from comedians. *Scripps News.* Retrieved from https://scrippsnews.com/stories/why-audiences-are-getting-their-news-from-comedians/

Jayan, B. T. V. (2020, July 30). What's so funny? The science of laughter. *The Hindu BusinessLine.* Retrieved from https://www.thehindubusinessline.com/blink/cover/whats-so-funny-the-science-of-laughter/article32231485.ece

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE AND SERVICE

Research Consultant — The Unscripted Project; *2021 - 2023*

Digital Media Coordinator — International Communication Association
Communication Science & Biology Interest Group — *2020 - 2022*

Member, Professional Development Committee — University of Pennsylvania
Annenberg School for Communication — *2019- 2021*

Graduate Associate — University of Pennsylvania
Riepe College House — *2017 - 2020*

Graduate Student Intern in Data Science — Vivar Inc., *2019*

Member, RAGA Training Committee — University of Pennsylvania
College Housing and Academic Services — *2019*

Member, Graduate Student Symposium Committee — University of Pennsylvania
Annenberg School for Communication — *2018*

Member, Graduate Student Council — University of Pennsylvania
Annenberg School for Communication — *2017- 2018*

REVIEWING

Human Communication Research	*2025*
Communication and Race Journal	*2025*
Social and Affective Neuroscience Society, Annual Conference	*2025*
International Communication Association, Annual Conferences	*2016 – 2021, 2025*
Social Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience Journal	*2024*
International Journal of Humor	*2020*

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

International Communication Association
National Communication Association
Social and Affective Neuroscience Society

American Political Science Association
Critical Humor Studies Association

WORKSHOPS ATTENDED

MIND: Methods In Neuroscience at Dartmouth *Aug 2018*
Advanced methods in brain-imaging analysis, with focus on naturalistic stimuli and developing open science work ethic. Held at Dartmouth College.

EEGLAB Workshop *Nov 2018*
Basic to advanced analysis of EEG data using EEGLAB toolbox in MATLAB. Held at University of California, San Diego.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Coding	Python, R, Matlab, SQL, Javascript
Analysis	Statistics (structural equation modeling, hierarchical modeling, panel data analysis), Machine Learning (autoencoders, neural networks, deep convolutional neural networks)
Research	Survey Design (Qualtrics, Amazon MTurk), Experimental Design (social science, neuroimaging research)

LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY

English, Hindi